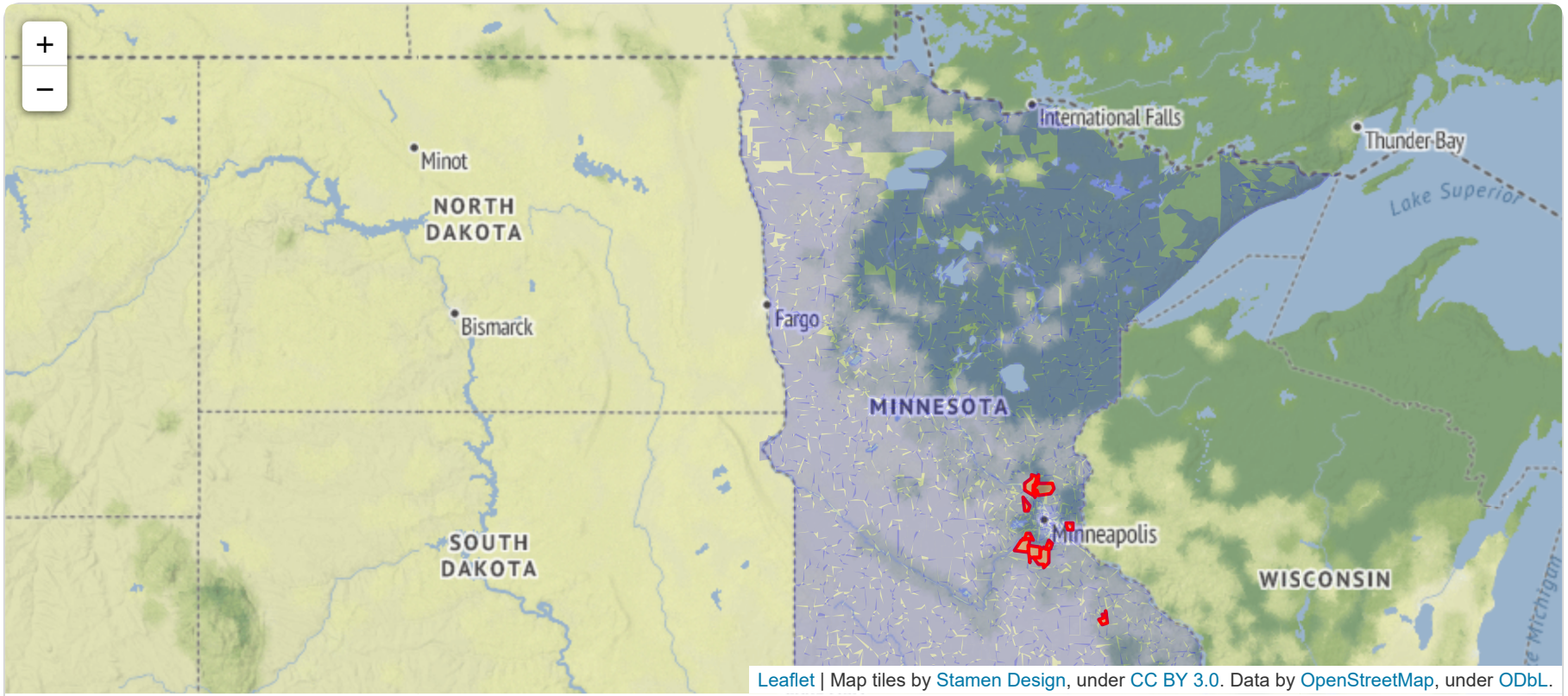


Local Account Intelligence

COLLEGES, COMMUNITY

in the state of Minnesota

Know the Market



Top zip codes for consumer spending on college tuition

[Source: 2025 EASI Demographics]

Colleges, Community

Includes category intelligence for community colleges or junior colleges.

Industry Background

Primary NAICS Code: *611210*
Junior Colleges

Primary SIC Code: *8221*
Colleges, Universities, and Professional Schools

Industry Intel

Community colleges trace their origin to Joliet Junior College, which was started in the early 1900s. The vast majority of these schools are public institutions and, as such, non-profit and thus may select vendors through bidding processes that must comply with local, state and federal law with respect to nondiscrimination, etc.

These institutions serve local area residents with two-year post-high school programs.

The colleges usually train students to assume community-based careers that include law enforcement, firefighting, nursing, and radiology. Some students use community colleges as a platform to university-level education and transfer to state colleges and universities upon completing the community college degree program. Most community college students are employed full or part-time while they are enrolled in classes.

Community colleges in the U.S. serve about 752,000 students in certificate programs and enroll nearly 20% of students in dual enrollment. The community college industry reached $75.2 billion in revenue in 2025. There are 370 businesses in this industry, and individual campuses total around 1,000 to 1,400 . For public community colleges, the average tuition is approximately $3,860 per year for in-state students.

Funding for these colleges is as follows:

- State government funding - 34.4%
- Local government funding - 22.4%
- Tuition and fees - 20.2%
- Federal government funding - 14.7%
- Other sources (grants, contracts) - 8.3%

[Sources: "DataPoints: Revenue by source." ccdaily.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "5 Community College Trends That Give an Edge in 2026." eab.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Good fall enrollment growth, but..." ccdaily.com, 2026. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Community Colleges in the US Industry Analysis, 2025." ibisworld.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "US Community College Market Analysis, Size, and Forecast 2025." technavio.com, 2024. Web. 28 Jan. 2026.]

Establishment+Employment Count

There are estimated to be 11 companies of this type (*Junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools*) in the state of Minnesota employing approximately 691 people.
[Source: 2025 EASI Demographics]

Items commonly offered by Colleges, Community

- Night and weekend classes
- Financial aid available
- Career placement assistance
- Highly qualified/specialized faculty
- Accelerated courses
- Online classes
- Free parking
- State-of-the-art equipment
- Full-service bookstore
- Associate, baccalaureate degrees and certificates

Executive Summary

6.5% of US adults said "College tuition for you or a family member (not student loan debt)" when asked "When it comes to personal, financial or professional services or investments, I expect to pay for the following in the next 12 months..."

Top sales months for Colleges, Community are: January, August.

The Annual Advertising/Marketing Budget is approximately **0.69%** of retail sales -
This amounts to an estimated ad budget of **$4,862,109** per location for average size junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools in the state of Minnesota. To be average in this market, junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools need to spend **$77,400** per employee on advertising every year. In the state of Minnesota there is an estimated **$53,483,204** in ad revenue.

30.9% of U.S. adults believe that colleges/universities (including trade schools) are credible in what they say and do, and have their best interest at heart.

You can confidently lead with social network advertising as a conversion driver, not just an awareness tactic. **80% of College Tuition Buyers** took action after seeing an ad on a social network in the past year.

College Tuition Buyers are **206% more likely** to read a blog every day.

Source: Exclusive research from AdMall, SalesFuel and our reliable partners - not available from AI.

Know the Opportunities

Limited-Time Opportunities+Shareables

Upcoming National Event Tie-Ins

- National Drunk and Drugged Driving Prevention Month
- National STD Education & Awareness Month
- Community College Month
- National Poetry Month
- National Sexual Assault Awareness & Prevention Month
- Audio Book Appreciation Month
- National Hispanic Heritage Month
- National Bullying Prevention Month
- National Family Literacy Day

Opportunities+Challenges

Dual enrollment now represents nearly 20% of all community college students with a 5.9% increase this fall, meaning high school partnerships have become a core revenue driver rather than a supplementary program. This segment reached 1.19 million students, cementing dual enrollment as a strategic pillar for sustainable growth.

Source: Good Fall Enrollment Growth, But..., Community College Daily, 2026

Certificate programs have exploded to 752,000 enrollments, up 28.3% since fall 2021, indicating that short-term credentials are now outpacing traditional associate degrees in student demand and growth trajectory. Certificate enrollment grew 1.9% this fall while associate degrees climbed 2.2%, both vastly outpacing bachelor's program growth at 0.9%.

Source: Postsecondary Enrollment Rises as Academic Trends Shift, National Student Clearinghouse Research Center, 2025

Freshman enrollment growth slowed to just 0.5% from a prior 6.7%, signaling missed connections in the youth pipeline and an urgent need to boost local visibility of dual enrollment opportunities.

Source: ccdaily.com, 2026. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.

At least half of community college courses are now offered online, reflecting permanent shifts in how students view educational delivery and creating a competitive advantage for colleges who fully embrace remote and hybrid options.

Source: "Mitigating the Impact of the 2026-2027 Enrollment Cliff." Carnegie Higher Ed, 2025. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.

Community colleges are down approximately 250,000 students from pre-pandemic peaks, meaning recovery remains incomplete despite three years of positive growth and enrollment gains outpacing other higher education sectors.

Source: "Mitigating the Impact of the 2026-2027 Enrollment Cliff." Carnegie Higher Ed, 2025. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.



Over 37 million Americans aged 18 to 64 have some college experience but no credential, representing an enormous untapped market for community colleges focused on completion and credential attainment. This population typically seeks flexibility, support and clear pathways that community colleges are uniquely positioned to provide.

Source: "Mitigating the Impact of the 2026-2027 Enrollment Cliff." Carnegie Higher Ed, 2025. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.



Students now discover colleges through AI search before reaching their website, and Reddit continues to shape trust through real student conversations outside official channels.

Source: manaferra.com, 2026. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.



Leveraging short-form video and authentic, plain-language content that highlights real student experiences meets students' growing preference for credible, unpolished storytelling over traditional brochures and static pages.

Source: rosica.com, 2025. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.



Flat tuition under growing state budget pressures is squeezing operations, making it critical to emphasize ROI and employer partnerships in funding and stakeholder pitches.

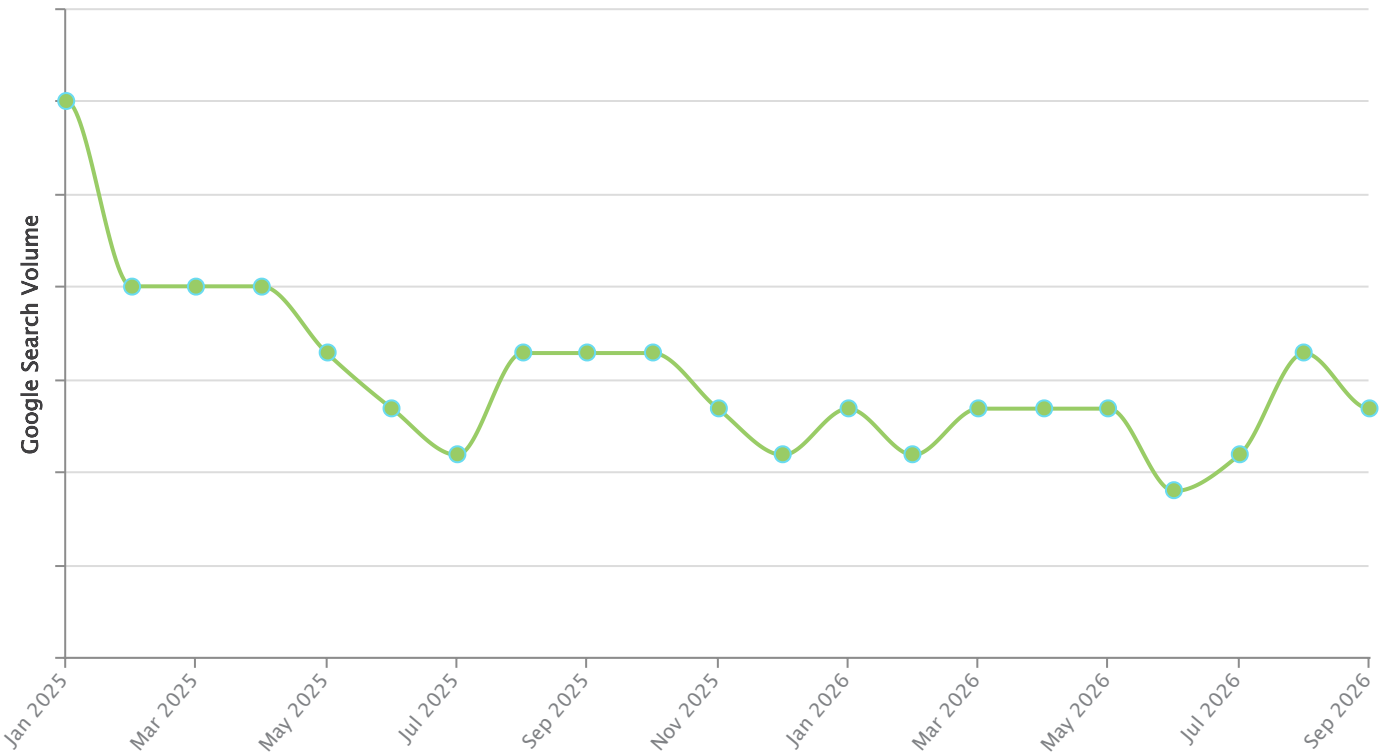
Source: eab.com, 2025. Web. 29 Jan. 2026.

Discovery Questions

- How are you capturing students in AI search summaries and monitoring unfiltered conversations on Reddit where they're already researching colleges?
- Are you segmenting audiences by their distinct motivations rather than using one broad campaign to reach everyone?
- Which workforce credentials drive the most applications, and what ROI challenges do you face in promoting them?

Know the Category

Peak Interest Months



Graph displays the trend line of search volume for this industry over the last 12 months. Source: DataforSEO November 02, 2026

Average GDP Per Location/Employee

The average market value of goods and services produced by labor and property (gross domestic product) for junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools

The average annual GDP for junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools is **$704,653,545** per location in the state of Minnesota. **$11,217,350** per employee in the state of Minnesota.

Peak Sales Months/Seasons

✓ January	*February*
March	*April*
May	*June*
July	✓ August
September	*October*
November	*December*

Sales peak around enrollment cycles, with August leading at roughly 25% of annual volume due to fall starts, followed by January at about 20% for spring terms. Activity is moderate in May and September, while summer months—especially June and July—lag as summer sessions drive less demand, with December consistently the lowest.

[Sources: "Community Colleges in the US Industry Analysis, 2025." ibisworld.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026.]

Top Product Categories

- Academic coursework to earn an associate degree and certificates
- Occupational education or training
- Transfer assistance to public 4-year post-secondary institution
- Noncredit activities, including remedial coursework

Annual Advertising/Marketing Budget

approximately **0.69%** of retail sales -
[Source: Weiner, George. "University & Higher Education Fundraising Study." wholewhale.com. 2024. Web. 17 Jun. 2025.]
This amounts to an estimated ad budget of **$4,862,109** per location for average size junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools in the state of Minnesota. To be average in this market, junior colleges, colleges, universities, and professional schools need to spend **$77,400** per employee on advertising every year. In the state of Minnesota there is an estimated **$53,483,204** in ad revenue.

[Source: 2025 EASI/AdMall Annual Receipts Analysis based the latest reported data from the IRS, US Bureau of Economic Analysis, and the US Census Bureau.]

Top Advertising Media Used

NON-DIGITAL

- Local partnerships - Joint events with high schools, employers and chambers; create direct student pipelines.
- Print direct mail - Targeted postcards and brochures to high school grads and adults; high ROI for nontraditional students.
- Grassroots engagement - Career fairs, open houses and community events; foster personal connections.
- High school visits - Counselors and dual enrollment pitches; key for recent grads.
- Billboards and local print ads - Visibility in high-traffic areas and newspapers; reinforce brand locally.

[Sources: “Which Marketing Strategies Provide the Best ROI for Community Colleges.” aperturecm.com, n.d. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; “The 2026 Marketing Playbook for Small Colleges.” howpotent.com, 2026. Web. 28 Jan. 2026.]

DIGITAL

- Search engine optimization (SEO) - Tops searches for programs and aid; boosts visibility in local queries
- Social media advertising - Targets via Facebook, Instagram, TikTok and LinkedIn; key for adult learners (19.7% enrollment growth in 25+ group)
- Personalized campaigns - Tailors ads for stopped-out students or applicants; improves conversions on apps like TikTok
- Retargeting campaigns - Reminds site visitors to apply or explore; nurtures leads effectively
- YouTube content - Program overviews and tours; primary research spot for prospects

[Sources: “Social Media Marketing in 2025 – Where Should Community Colleges Be.” aperturecm.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; “2026 Higher Ed Marketing Outlook.” eab.com, 2026. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; “Five Digital Marketing Strategies for Community Colleges.” carnegiehighered.com, 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026.]

Digital Video Ideas for Colleges, Community



Southwest Tennessee Community College



LCCC



Piedmont Virginia Community College



Tulsa Community College

Know the Customers

Target Customers

- Recent high school graduates ages 18 to 20 are the largest customer segment for community colleges, with 18-year-old freshman enrollment up 5% in fall 2024 and this group representing a significant share of the 39% of all U.S. undergraduates enrolled in community colleges due to affordability and dual-enrollment access.
- Hispanic students rank second, accounting for 49% of all Hispanic undergraduates and 28% of total community college enrollment, driving much of the 3.9% headcount increase to 10.5 million students in fall 2024, particularly in diverse urban markets.
- Dual-enrolled high school students place third, making up 20.4% of enrollment, with 2.8 million participants nationwide in 2023–24 (up 12.7%), and 71% enrolled at community colleges as participation increased 11% year over year.
- Low-income Pell Grant recipients follow, as high-Pell community colleges recorded 8.6% enrollment growth in fall 2024—twice the rate of low-Pell institutions—reflecting demand for flexible, affordable education during economic uncertainty.
- Adults aged 25 and older round out the top five, with enrollment up 6% in fall 2025 in some states and national gains of 5.9% among ages 25 to 29, driven by demand for part-time credentials and upskilling.

[Sources:"AACC Fast Facts 2025." Community College Daily. ccdaily.com. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "What Do the Latest Enrollment Trends Tell Us About Community Colleges." ACCT. acct.org. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "5 Community College Trends That Give an Edge in 2026." EAB. eab.com. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Enrollment." American Association of Community Colleges. aacc.nche.edu. n.d. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Student Enrollment Is Up This Fall at Tennessee's Community and Technical Colleges." Tennessee Board of Regents. tbr.edu. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Current Term Enrollment Estimates." National Student Clearinghouse Research Center. nscresearchcenter.org. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026]

Target Customers by Mile Radius

Most customers are drawn from a 47 mile radius. Approximately how many miles patrons travel to these businesses based on proprietary data.
[SalesFuel.com, 2025.]

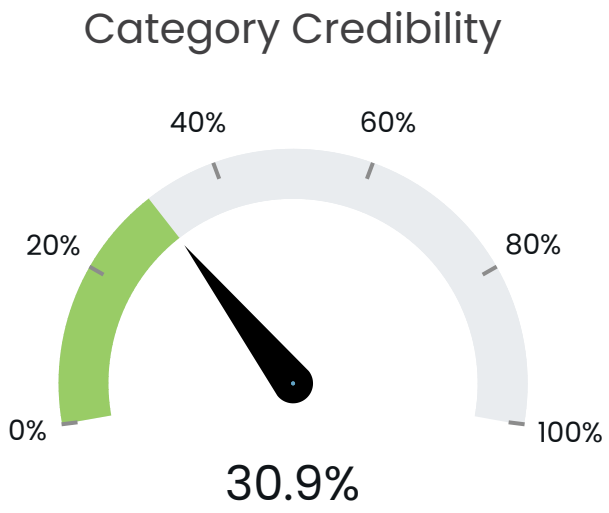
Top Factors People Consider When Choosing This Type Of Account

- Affordability ranks as the top criterion for choosing community colleges, with low tuition attracting 39% of U.S. undergraduates, particularly recent high school graduates and low-income students facing financial pressure.
- Proximity and commuting distance rank second, cited as a leading factor for female students at a mean of 3.66, with a median travel distance of 17 miles and 69% of students living within 50 miles, making local access critical for commuters, working adults, and families.
- Availability of desired programs and majors places third, influencing both genders at mean scores ranging from 3.18 to 3.47 and shaping long-term goals such as transfer pathways and workforce entry, with 56% of community college awards concentrated in vocational certificates and associate credentials.
- Athletics, sports, and extracurricular activities rank first among student-athletes at a mean of 4.24 and also support broader engagement through campus life and dual-enrollment pathways, which account for 20.4% of total enrollment.
- Quality of coaching staff and academic support ranks fifth at a mean of 3.59, playing a key role in retention and student success, with high-Pell institutions posting 8.6% enrollment growth by prioritizing advising and support services.

[Sources: "What Do the Latest Enrollment Trends Tell Us About Community Colleges." acct.org. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "AACC Fast Facts 2025." Community College Daily. ccdaily.com. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "5 Community College Trends That Give an Edge in 2026." EAB. eab.com. 2025. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "Factors Influencing the College Choice Decisions of Community College Student-Athletes." OpenPrairie. openprairie.sdstate.edu. n.d. Web. 28 Jan. 2026; "10 Tips for Choosing the Best Community College for You." Uprooted Academy. uprootedacademy.org. n.d. Web. 28 Jan. 2026]

Category Trust+Credibility

> *30.9% of U.S. Adults believe the marketing practices of colleges/universities (including trade schools) are credible*



	Audience	All Respondents	Difference
65+	**24.1%**	21.6%	**+12%**
35-44	19.3%	18.2%	+6%
18-24	9.3%	9.6%	-3%
55-64	17.5%	18.5%	-5%
45-54	14.8%	15.8%	-6%
25-34	15.1%	16.6%	-9%

"More likely" or "less likely" than the average U.S. adult 18+.

Credibility - and whether a person has it or not - determines who you trust for guidance and information you use to make decisions in your everyday life. The four components of credibility for any human being are (1) being known, (2) being likable, (3) being helpful, and (4) being trustworthy. Credibility is gained (or lost) by what one says, how they say it, what they do and, finally, what others say about them. Having credibility also requires having others' best interests at heart.

SOURCE: 2026 State of Credibility 2026 Methodology

Trust Drivers

69.1% of U.S. adults **do not indicate a belief that the marketing** of colleges/universities (including trade schools) is credible. The following responses are from this audience of consumers.

> *What are the best ways for a company to demonstrate their credibility, trustworthiness and value through their marketing practices?*

Marketing Practice	Audience
Being transparent about what their product or service can and cannot do	65.1%
Showing real customers and authentic experiences rather than overly polished or staged advertising	62.9%
Making pricing, fees and terms easy to find without having to dig for them	53.5%
Clearly disclosing when their content is sponsored, paid or AI-generated	46.9%
Responding publicly and personally to negative reviews rather than ignoring them	44.8%
Providing and standing behind a clear, easy-to-use refund or satisfaction guarantee	44.4%
Taking a clear, consistent and authentic stand on values without changing them based on trends	38.7%
Showing the real people behind the business rather than hiding behind a brand	37.1%
Being visibly involved in and giving back to their community	35.3%
Being findable and well-represented across Google, AI search and review platforms	23.8%
Displaying third-party recognition such as industry awards, certifications, accreditations, or media coverage	19.4%
Emailing, calling and/or texting me less often	17.3%

How do you tell if a company you've never heard of before is legitimate?

Vetting Method	Audience
I search for them on Google or another search engine.	55.6%
I look for reviews on sites like Yelp, Trustpilot or Google Reviews.	47.6%
I ask friends, family or colleagues if they've heard of them.	44.6%
I ask myself if the offer seems too good to be true.	39.8%
I check their Better Business Bureau rating or complaints.	38.6%
I check for their professional-looking website with a physical address and phone number.	37.6%
I look for industry certifications, association memberships or if they're licensed in my state.	34.5%
If I have any doubts, I simply move on and look for someone else.	32.5%
I check their social media presence to see how active, responsive and authentic they are.	27%
I search for them on an AI assistant like ChatGPT.	16.1%

SOURCE: 2026 State of Credibility 2026 Methodology

Interests+Attitudes

Additional intelligence for audiences often targeted by colleges, community from AudienceSCAN®

- College class attendees (work or personal fulfillment)
- New Career Skill Seekers
- College Tuition Buyers

Digital Usage: College Tuition Buyers

> *6.5% of U.S. adults said "College tuition for you or a family member (not student loan debt)" when asked: "When it comes to personal, financial or professional services or investments, I expect to pay for the following in the next 12 months....."*

206%
More likely to
Read a Blog Every Day
(69.8% of audience)

22%
More likely to
Research a product or service on a local store website before purchasing
(31.7% of audience)

43%
Less likely to
Go Past First Search Page Results

(26.7% of audience)

I enjoy sharing my experiences with products/stores on social media

Rank		Audience	All U.S.	Difference
1	If I have a GOOD experience with a product or store, I will usually share it with my friends using social media or by posting a positive review	**39.3**	26.4	49.0
2	If I have a BAD experience with a product or store, I will usually share it using social media or by posting a negative review	25.5	16.6	**54.0**

"College Tuition Buyers" are defined by 2026 AudienceSCAN®
"More likely" or "less likely" than the average U.S. adult 18+.
SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

B2C Advertising Response: College Tuition Buyers

> *When have you last seen/heard an advertisement of this type that led you to take action?*

Past 30 Days

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Differen
1	Ad on a social network	**50.7%**	35.9%	+41%
2	Online display ads (banners and pop-up ads)	45.4%	30%	**+51%**
3	Streaming TV advertising (such as Hulu, Pluto TV or YouTube TV)	**48.8%**	36.7%	+33%
4	Ad on search results pages (like on Google, Yahoo or Bing)	**48.2%**	35.8%	+35%
5	Ad that plays before or during the video you want to watch	44.9%	31.1%	+44%
6	Mobile phone app or text message	**47.4%**	36.6%	+30%
7	Television (traditional, including cable or satellite subscription)	**45.8%**	34.7%	+32%
8	Emailed ad or newsletter	41.5%	28.6%	+45%

Past Year

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Difference
1	Ad on a social network	**80%**	59.2%	+35%
2	Ad on search results pages (like on Google, Yahoo or Bing)	**79%**	59.7%	+32%
3	Online display ads (banners and pop-up ads)	75.4%	53.1%	+42%
4	Ad that plays before or during the video you want to watch	74.8%	53.5%	+40%
5	Streaming TV advertising (such as Hulu, Pluto TV or YouTube TV)	**76.8%**	58.2%	+32%
6	Mobile phone app or text message	**76.5%**	58.1%	+32%
7	Television (traditional, including cable or satellite subscription)	**76.8%**	60%	+28%

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Differen
9	Text link ad on a website	40%	27.3%	+47%
10	Ads at movie theater	35.2%	21.5%	**+64%**
11	Outdoor ad/sign/billboard/transit	36%	23.6%	**+53%**
12	Ads/Coupons in your mailbox	40.4%	29.9%	+35%
13	Radio (over-the-air, online, mobile or tablet)	37.3%	25.5%	+46%
14	Newspaper (print, online, mobile or tablet)	35.3%	23.5%	**+50%**
15	Magazine (print, online, mobile or on tablet)	32.9%	21.5%	**+53%**
16	Ad on a podcast	33.8%	22.7%	+49%
17	Advertising circulars in your mailbox or inserted in the newspaper	35.7%	27.2%	+31%

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Difference
8	Radio (over-the-air, online, mobile or tablet)	70.3%	47.6%	**+48%**
9	Emailed ad or newsletter	73%	52.8%	+38%
10	Outdoor ad/sign/billboard/transit	68.9%	46.1%	**+49%**
11	Ads at movie theater	65.9%	42.6%	**+55%**
12	Ads/Coupons in your mailbox	72.6%	56.2%	+29%
13	Text link ad on a website	69.1%	49.5%	+40%
14	Newspaper (print, online, mobile or tablet)	66%	44.7%	**+48%**
15	Magazine (print, online, mobile or tablet)	65.3%	44%	**+48%**
16	Ad on a podcast	63.5%	42.5%	**+49%**
17	Advertising circulars in your mailbox or inserted in the newspaper	68%	52.2%	+30%

SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

* % total may not equal 100% because audience could select more than one answer to this question.

Did You Know

> ***College Tuition Buyers*** *are* ***50% more likely*** *to take action by checking a company's blog to check reviews on the advertiser after seeing an ad.*

> *When* ***College Tuition Buyers*** *search a business online,* ***30.7%*** *usually have a company name in mind.*

> ***College Tuition Buyers*** *are* ***81% more likely*** *to check a company's blog to evaluate their expertise and subject knowledge than the average U.S. adult.*

> ***College Tuition Buyers*** *in the U.S. are* ***134%*** *more likely to participate in* ***playing esports*** *than the average adult.*

SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

Know the Competition

Top Major Accounts and Franchises

Colleges, Community

Strategic Education, Inc.

Local Competitors

Colleges, Community

Other similar or related local account types to colleges, community in your market.

- Technical and Trade Schools
- Colleges, Universities, and Professional Schools
- Beauty and Barber Schools
- Training Services, Corporate Trainers
- Colleges, For Profit

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